Admin guide

For: PEA admins. **Version:** 3, October 2026.

As an admin you can do everything an HR user can (see the HR guide), on every screen, whatever module access says. You also:

- look after the **HR accounts** and decide which screens each HR user sees;
- **change settings** and **email templates**;
- run the **Excel import**;
- read **Sent emails**, the log of every email PEA has sent;
- choose who receives the **new joiner review email** (hr2@);
- **delete** a Commando created by mistake.

Super Admins (see the Super Admin guide) also look after admins.

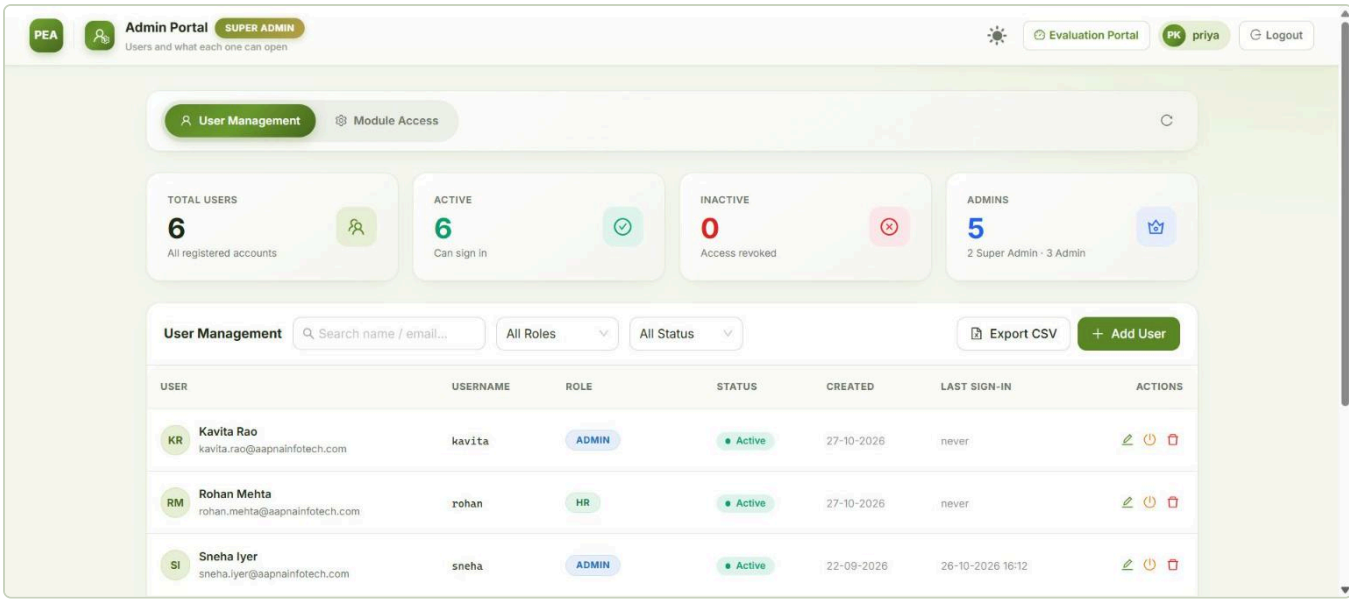
Contents

1. Opening the Admin Portal
2. Users
3. Module access: who sees which screens
4. Settings
5. Email templates
6. Upload Excel
7. Sent emails
8. The new joiner review email (hr2@)
9. Deleting a Commando
10. Housekeeping checklist

---

1. Opening the Admin Portal

Click **Admin Portal** in the top bar. It has two tabs, **User Management** and **Module Access**, and a refresh button. **Evaluation Portal** (top right) takes you back to PEA, and **Logout** signs you out.



The Admin Portal

2. Users

User Management shows counts (**Total Users**, **Active**, **Inactive**, **Admins**) and the list of accounts with their username, role, status, created date and last sign-in. Search by name or email, and filter by role and status. **Export CSV** downloads every account as a list you can open in Excel.

Add a user

1. Click **Add User**.
2. Fill in **First Name**, **Last Name** and **Email Address**. **Username** is optional; left blank, they sign in with their email.
3. Choose the **Role**. As an admin you can create **Admin** and **HR** accounts.
4. Type a **Password** (at least 10 characters, not containing their name) and confirm it, or click **Auto-Generate Password** and **Copy** it.
5. Click **Create User**. PEA emails the sign-in details to the person's own inbox. If that email could not be sent, PEA says so; give them the password yourself.

Change a user: the pencil icon. Change the name, username, role or **Account Status**. To reset their password, type a **New Password** (blank keeps the current one). Changing the role or password, or deactivating, signs them out everywhere at once.

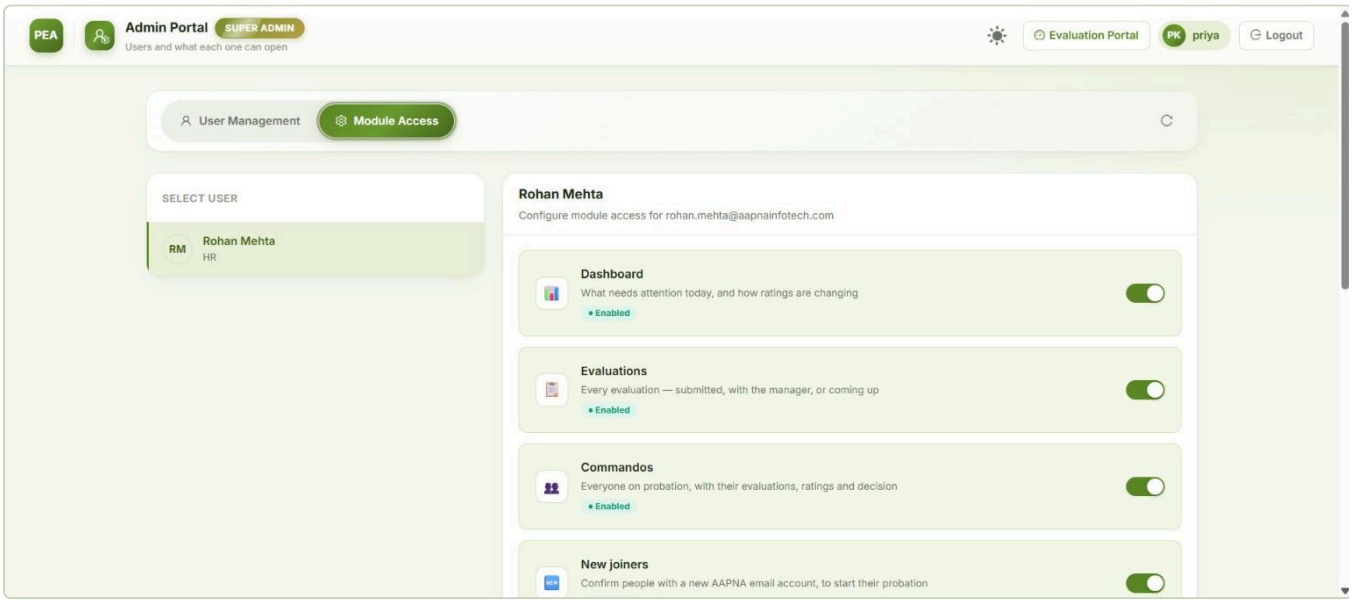
Deactivate rather than delete. The power icon deactivates: they are signed out immediately and cannot sign in until reactivated. Their history stays. Only a Super Admin can delete an account.

What you can't do (by design):

Rule	Why
You can't change your own role or status	Nobody can lock themselves in or out by mistake
You can't edit, reset or deactivate another admin	Admins are peers; a Super Admin manages admins
You can't change a Super Admin's account	Only Super Admins can
You change your own password from the menu under your name	Not from User Management

3. Module access: who sees which screens

Module Access: pick an HR user on the left, then switch each screen on or off for them. Changes save as you click (✓ **Auto-saved**) and reach the person within a minute.



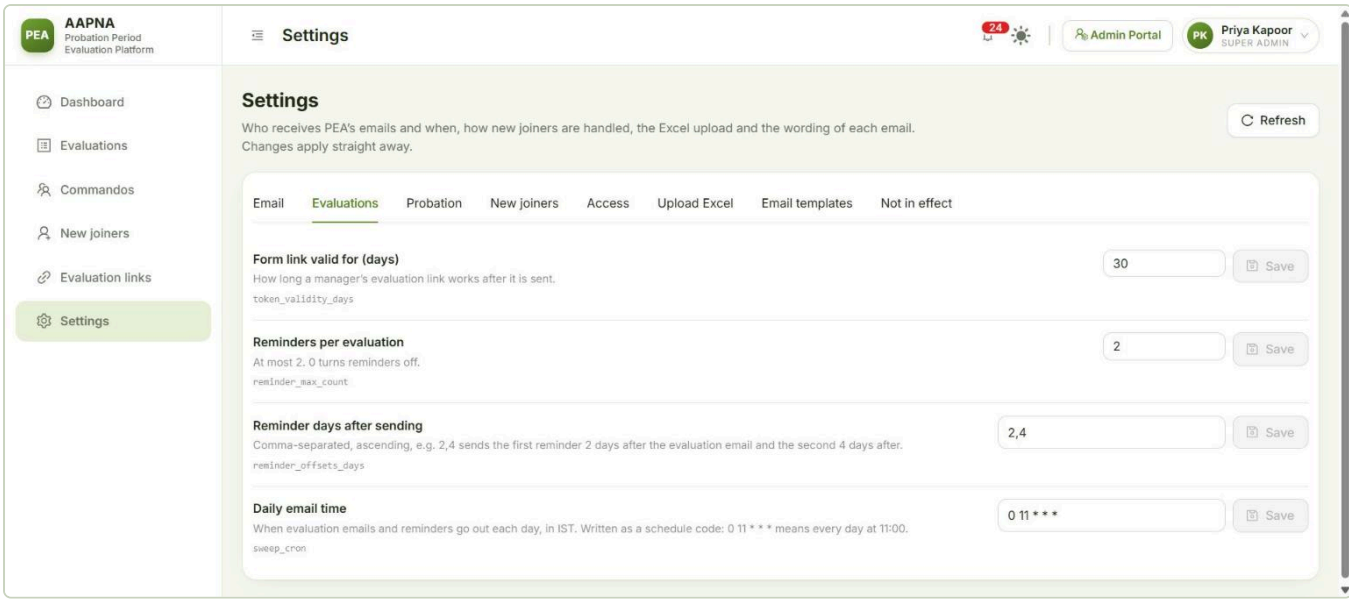
Module access

Module	Screen
Dashboard	The Dashboard (Needs action)
Evaluations	The Evaluations board and each evaluation's page
Commandos	The Commandos list and each Commando's page, Commando links
New joiners	New joiners: the Microsoft 365 check, confirming joiners, possible leavers
Evaluation links	Manager team links and Commando links
Settings	The settings tabs (read-only for HR)
↳ Trends	The Trends tab inside the Dashboard
↳ Upload Excel	The Upload Excel tab inside Settings
↳ Email templates	The Email templates tab inside Settings (read-only for HR)

- **Settings** shows in the sidebar if any one of Settings, Upload Excel or Email templates is on; the user sees only the tabs that are on.
- Admins and Super Admins always see everything. The switches apply to HR users only.
- **Admin Portal access** is not a switch: make the person an Admin to give it.
- An HR user with every module off sees "No modules are enabled for your account".

4. Settings

Settings is read-only for HR; only admins can change it. Each setting saves on its own and applies straight away. Changes to the important ones (marked as such) are announced to every admin through the bell.



Settings

Email

Setting	What it does
Pause all email	Normally **off**. On (emergency only): nothing leaves PEA; emails are listed in **Sent emails** as "would have sent". The top bar then shows **No email is being sent** to everyone
CC on evaluation emails	Copied on every evaluation request and reminder, alongside the project leader
HR notification recipients	Receive "evaluation submitted", "probation extended", and the deadline digest
"Report to IT" recipients	Where **Report to IT** corrections go. Needed before Report to IT works in production
Never copy these as project leader	People not to copy just because they are listed as project leader (they are still copied if they are the manager or on the CC list)
Copy HR on manager team-link emails	On: a manager's "my team" email is copied to HR and the CC list

Evaluations

Setting	Default	What it does
Form link valid for (days)	30	How long a manager's form link works after it is sent
Reminders per evaluation	2	At most 2; 0 turns reminders off
Reminder days after sending	2,4	First reminder 2 days after the evaluation email, the second 4 days after

Setting	Default	What it does
Daily email time	11:00 IST	When evaluation emails and reminders go out each day. The box writes the time as minutes, then hour, then `* * *`: 11:00 is `0 11 * * *`, and 10:30 would be `30 10 * * *`

Probation

Setting	Default	What it does
Archive Commandos this many days after the probation ends	0	0 = the morning after the decision or exit
Confirmation deadline (months)	6	A decision must be recorded this many months after joining
Deadline once extended (months)	8	The same after an extension
Email HR a daily deadline digest		On: HR is emailed daily about probations whose decision is overdue. The Dashboard and bell show them either way

New joiners

Setting	What it does
Nightly Microsoft 365 check / Daily Microsoft 365 check time	Whether the daily check runs, and when (09:00 IST by default, two hours before the evaluation emails). **Scan now** works either way
Look back for new accounts (days)	How far back the check looks for new accounts (45 by default)
Joiner email domains	Only email addresses ending in one of these are treated as joiners (aapnainfotech.com, mera.work, karyakeeper.com)
Contractor list / Leaders list	The Microsoft 365 groups PEA uses to leave contract staff out and to suggest each joiner's project leader. Change only if IT tells you the groups have changed
Never offer these as joiners / System mailboxes	Addresses the check always leaves out
New accounts with no manager in Microsoft 365	**Leave out**: they wait until IT sets a manager (the screen names them). **Show**: they appear with the manager marked "Missing"
Designation words that suggest Fresher / Experienced	Words in the job title that pre-select the track. Only a suggestion; HR always confirms
Send the new joiner review email to	**hr2@aapnainfotech.com** by default. The daily "new joiners waiting" email goes only here, with Confirm (or Review) and Not confirm buttons. The buttons open PEA, so acting on them needs a PEA sign-in (section 8). Blank: it goes to every admin and HR user, without buttons

Setting	What it does
Let the scan update names and emails	Overwrites unlocked names and office emails with Microsoft 365's. Do a **Test run** first
Hold evaluations when Microsoft 365 says someone has left	On (default): evaluations stop as soon as IT switches the account off, before HR confirms
Email HR when the Microsoft 365 check goes wrong	On (default): HR is told once about each problem (check failed, joiner with no manager)
Show the manual pause button	Off by default. Switch on for long leave (sabbatical, maternity), when the account stays active

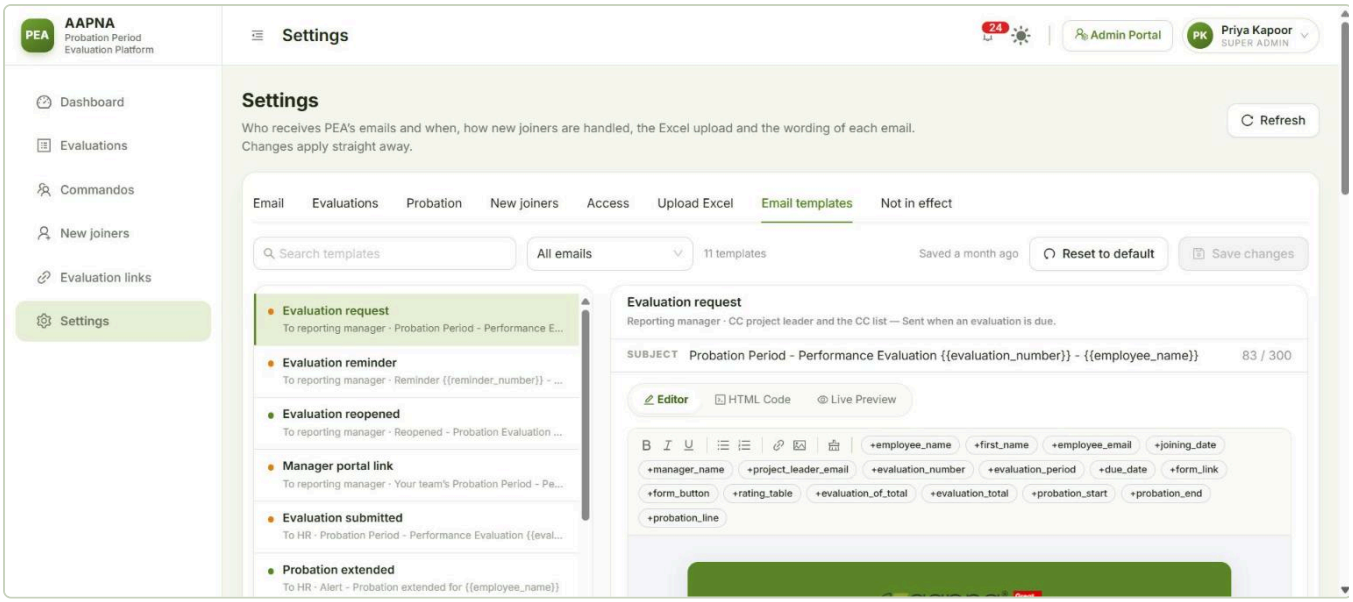
Access

Setting	What it does
Manager portal link valid for (days)	How long a manager's "my team" link works (30 by default). A new link revokes the previous one
Commando self-view	What a Commando sees through their own link: **off** (the link does not open), **schedule** (dates and status), **averages** (plus their averages and the decision; the default) or **full** (plus every rating and the manager's comments)

5. Email templates

Settings → **Email templates** lists every email PEA sends. Filter by **To reporting manager**, **To HR** or **To IT**.

Email	Goes to
Evaluation request	Reporting manager · CC project leader and the CC list
Evaluation reminder	Reporting manager · CC project leader and the CC list
Evaluation reopened	Whoever submitted it · CC project leader and the CC list
Manager portal link	Reporting manager
Evaluation submitted	HR notification recipients
Probation extended	HR notification recipients
Confirmation deadline digest	HR notification recipients (when switched on)
Evaluation report shared	Whoever HR sends it to
Microsoft 365 check alert	HR notification recipients
New joiners waiting for review	The review mailbox (hr2@)
Report to IT	"Report to IT" recipients · CC HR



Email templates

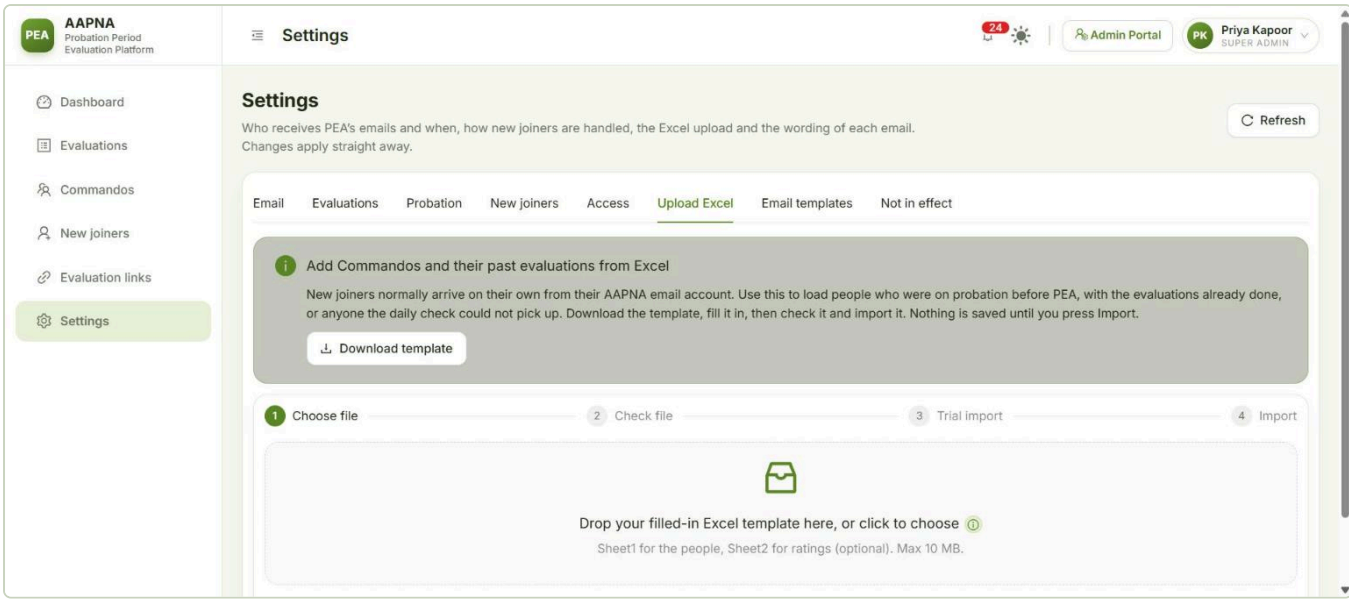
To change one:

1. Pick the email from the list (or search for it). Edit the **Subject** and the body in **Editor**. Leave the **HTML Code** tab to the PEA team.
2. Insert the details PEA fills in (the Commando's name, the due date, the form button…) with the + buttons above the editor, such as **+employee_name** or **+form_button**. In the text they appear as `{{employee_name}}`. Don't retype or change them; use the + buttons instead.
3. Check **Live Preview**, which fills the email with sample data. PEA refuses to save an email that has lost a required link (for example the form button on an evaluation request), or that uses a detail PEA does not know.
4. Click **Save changes**. The AAPNA logo, green header and footer are added automatically.

Reset to default brings back the original wording. A wrong template goes to every manager who receives that email, so always check the preview first.

6. Upload Excel

Settings → Upload Excel adds Commandos and their past evaluations from Excel. It is for loading history, and for people the Microsoft 365 check cannot pick up. Nothing is saved until the last step.



Upload Excel

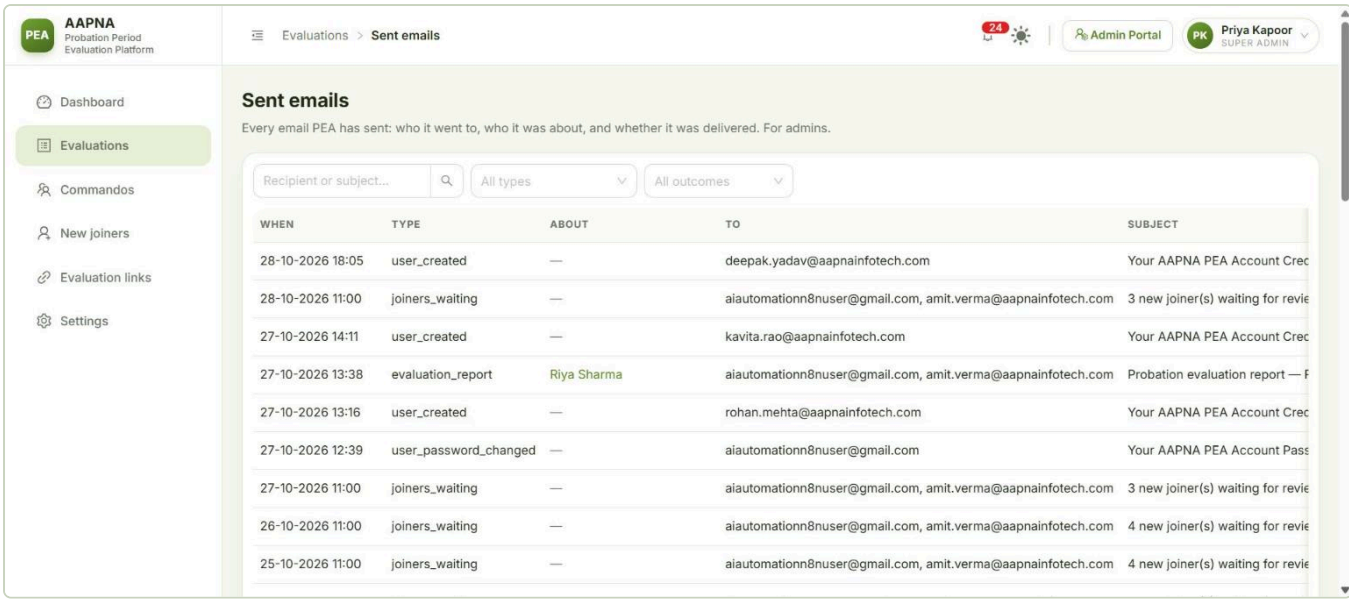
1. **Download template**, fill it in (Sheet1: one row per Commando; Sheet2, optional: the ratings). The old master workbook works too.
2. **Choose file** (any Excel file, up to 10 MB).
3. **Check file** reads every row and shows: rows read, ready, **refused** (with the reason for each), freshers and experienced, already decided, decision needed, and **which managers will be emailed** an evaluation at the next daily send. Fix refused rows in the file and check again.
4. **Trial import** goes through the whole import without saving: how many would be added, how many are already in PEA, and anything that would fail.
5. **Import** (admins only) asks you to confirm, then adds the Commandos with their evaluations and ratings.

Good to know:

- Anyone whose office email is already in PEA is **skipped, not changed**.
- An evaluation due in the last 45 days and not completed in the sheet is emailed to the manager at the next daily send. Anything due earlier is closed as history.
- Someone whose probation is already over with no decision in the sheet is imported as still on probation, with **Decision due** on their page. Record the decision there, or fill in Confirmation Status in the sheet first.
- HR users with Upload Excel switched on can check a file and do a trial import, but not import.

7. Sent emails

Evaluations → **Sent emails** (admins only) lists every email PEA has sent: **When**, **Type**, **About** (the Commando), **To**, **Subject** and **Outcome** (sent, failed, or would have sent while email was paused). Search by recipient or subject, and filter by type and outcome. Use it to check that a manager really was emailed.



Sent emails

8. The new joiner review email (hr2@)

When the Microsoft 365 check finds new joiners, and once a day at the daily email time while anyone is still waiting, PEA emails **hr2@aapnainfotech.com**. The email has a row per joiner: their name and email, what will be saved (account creation date, the date evaluations are counted from, fresher or experienced, manager, project leader), and two buttons.

Microsoft 365 found 1 new joiner. 1 more is still waiting.

Microsoft 365 does not hold the joining date or the years of experience, so each joiner is confirmed by HR before any evaluation is scheduled. PEA counts the evaluations from the account creation date in Microsoft 365 (AD) and suggests fresher or experienced from the designation. Each button opens New joiners in PEA with that joiner ready to confirm or remove — sign in if asked. Nothing changes until you press the button there.

Joiner	Will be saved as	Action
Rohan Mehta NEW rmehta@aapnainfotech.com	Account created 05-10-2026 · counted from 06-10-2026 Experienced ("Associate Software Engineer") Manager: Kavita Rao · PL: meera.pillai@aapnainfotech.com	Confirm Not confirm
Sneha Iyer siyer@aapnainfotech.com	Account created 02-10-2026 · counted from 03-10-2026 fresher / experienced not known ("Software Engineer") Manager: Kavita Rao · PL: missing	Review Not confirm Fresher or experienced is not known — choose it after pressing Review

The new joiner review email

Button	What happens
Confirm	Opens PEA on **New joiners** with this joiner's **Confirm** window already open and filled in. Check the details, then click **Add and schedule**: the person becomes a Commando and their evaluations are scheduled
Review (instead of Confirm)	Something must be filled in or chosen first. The line under the buttons says what, such as "Fresher or experienced is not known", or evaluations already past due. Opens the same **Confirm** window: fill in what is missing, then click **Add and schedule**

Button	What happens
Not confirm	Opens PEA on **New joiners** with this joiner's row highlighted and **Remove from the inbox?** already open on it. Click **OK** to remove the account from the list. Use it for accounts that are not new joiners. No evaluation is scheduled, and the account does not come back unless its Microsoft 365 account changes

- If you are not signed in to PEA, it asks you to sign in first, then opens the joiner straight away.
- The buttons never act on their own: they only open PEA. Nothing is saved until you click **Add and schedule** or **OK**. **Cancel** leaves the joiner waiting.
- Reading the hr2@ mailbox is not enough: you need a PEA account, as an Admin, a Super Admin, or an HR user with **New joiners** switched on (section 3). A forwarded email gives nobody access.
- PEA records who acted. A confirmed joiner's change history names you and says "Opened from the review email".
- If the joiner is no longer waiting (someone has already confirmed or removed them), PEA opens **New joiners** and says who did it, and when.
- Who receives this email is set in **Settings** → **New joiners** → **Send the new joiner review email to** (section 4).

9. Deleting a Commando

Only for demo and test records, or someone added by mistake. **More** → **Delete…** on the Commando's page, type their full name to confirm, and **Delete permanently**. Every evaluation, rating and the change history go with them, and other admins are notified.

If the person really left, use **More** → **Mark as left…** instead, which keeps their history.

10. Housekeeping checklist

Monthly, or when the HR team changes:

- [ ] People who left the HR team: **deactivate** their PEA account.
- [ ] New HR team members: create an **HR** account and set their **module access**.
- [ ] Dashboard → **Not sent yet** is 0. If not, open each one and fix it.
- [ ] Dashboard → **Act on these first**: nothing old left under **Deadline passed**.
- [ ] New joiners: nobody waiting for more than a few days, and **Possible leavers** dealt with.
- [ ] Settings → Email: the CC list and HR notification recipients are still the right people.
- [ ] **Pause all email** is off and the top bar does not say "No email is being sent".